

UBON EARBUDS

Blinkit Market Entry - Board Strategy



+24% YoY

ANC segment · Counterpoint 2026

5-7%

Blinkit return rate vs 25–30% Amazon

₹1,499

Skips ₹799 death zone · ANC visible

34.4%

Net margin (fast-sell velocity)

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Prepared for Your Growth Labs × Ubon Electronics · Scaler × YourGrowthLabs Case · May 2026 · Confidential

The Investment Case in One Slide

Five statements. Each verifiable. Everything else supports them.



ANC is accelerating - TWS is not.

TWS flat at +1% YoY (Counterpoint 2026). ANC devices +24% YoY. Sub-₹2,500 ANC is the fastest-growing band. Ubon enters at the right inflection point.



Blinkit-first is rational, not aspirational.

5–7% return rate vs 25–30% Amazon. Seller model: 10 dark stores, self-serve, no category-manager gate. The structural advantage is real.



₹1,499 deliberately skips the ₹799 death zone.

₹499 worked (impulse). ₹799 failed (scrutiny without trust). ₹1,499 with ANC: features visible in 3 seconds, margins meaningful at 34.4% fast-sell.



The consumer gap is trust — not features.

Survey n=18: 50% cite returns as top hesitation. 87%+ will Google before buying. No brand owns the returns promise sub-₹1,500 on Blinkit.



Validate at 10 dark stores. Then scale.

Seller model punishes slow sell-through with daily storage costs (~₹1/unit/day). Prove ROAS >4x before committing inventory capital to 100+ stores.

02 · Market Context

The Market Is Maturing. ANC Is Accelerating.

+24% YoY

ANC Devices 2025

Sub-₹2,500 ANC fastest band. Spatial audio +67% YoY.

Counterpoint, Feb 2026

1% YoY

Overall TWS 2025

First-time buyer pool exhausted. Replacement cycle begins.

Counterpoint, Feb 2026

~45%

Blinkit QC Share

\$6–7B QC GMV 2024. Electronics category expanding fast.

TechCrunch 2024

5-7%

Blinkit Returns

vs 25–30% Amazon. Structural reason for Blinkit-first.

YGL Session, May 2026

COMPETITIVE REALITY

boAt

~33% share · 10k+ reviews · ₹1,299 ANC

Losing share. Review moat = real but expensive. NOT our direct target.



Boult Audio

~10% share · ₹1,299 ANC · Made-in-India

PRIMARY COMPETITOR in our target band. Fast growing +10.8%.



OnePlus/realme

Highest-ever shipments 2025 · AI features <₹2,500

Ecosystem play. +21%/+22% YoY. Real threat in upgrade cycle.



Ubon

<1% share · BIS certification in progress

Execution gap - NOT a product gap. 250+ distributors. IPL equity.



03 · The ₹799 Death Zone - Why Failure Becomes the Blueprint

WORKED	FAILED	TARGET	FUTURE
₹499 ✓ Impulse · cheapest filter · no scrutiny	₹799 ✗ Death zone · invisible differentiation · no trust	₹1,499 ✓ ANC visible in 3 sec · MRP anchor · considered buy ← skip →	₹2,499+ ✓ Semi-premium · requires brand equity first

WHY ₹799 FAILED: Mic quality invisible on thumbnail · No review floor = no trust · Too many identical specs · Too expensive for impulse, too cheap for premium

04 · Market Entry Thesis

Why Now. Why Blinkit. Why Not Amazon. Why ₹1,499.



Why Now?

- ANC +24% YoY while TWS flat at +1%
- First TWS buyers (2021–22) entering replacement cycle
- Maturity creates room for credibility — not volume



Why Blinkit First?

- 5–7% return rate vs 25–30% Amazon - structural, not tactical
- Seller model: 10 dark stores, self-serve listing
- No category-manager dependency — launch in weeks



Why Not Amazon?

- Ubon exited after 25–30% return fraud (customers sent unrelated items)
- Re-entry via Flipkart vendor model (₹18Cr PO, June)
- Amazon only via vendor model - seller model = capital destroyer



Why ₹1,499?

- First price where ANC is visible and understood in 3 seconds
- First price where margins are meaningful (34.4% net, fast-sell)
- 40% MRP anchor: ₹2,499 → ₹1,499

★ Survey (n=18): 50% cite 'easy returns' as top Blinkit hesitation. No brand in sub-₹1,500 Blinkit TWS owns this slot. Zero-cost first-mover advantage.

05 · Positioning Strategy

Own One Use Case. One Signal. One Identity.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

"The no-regret work earbuds - clear calls, honest specs, returns in 60 seconds."

01

Own This Use Case

Best earbuds for office calls under ₹1,499

- 6-mic ENC = demonstrably clearer calls than all competitors at this price
- WFH buyer: daily use, lower return intent, repeat gifting potential
- Consumers FORGIVE average bass. They do NOT forgive call embarrassment.

02

Own This Signal

Easy returns as hero promise

- 50% cite returns as #1 Blinkit hesitation — nobody owns this
- Thumbnail badge: 'Easy Returns ✓' — more powerful than any spec claim
- Returns badge reduces perceived risk without reducing margin

03

Own This Identity

Consistent visual system across touchpoints

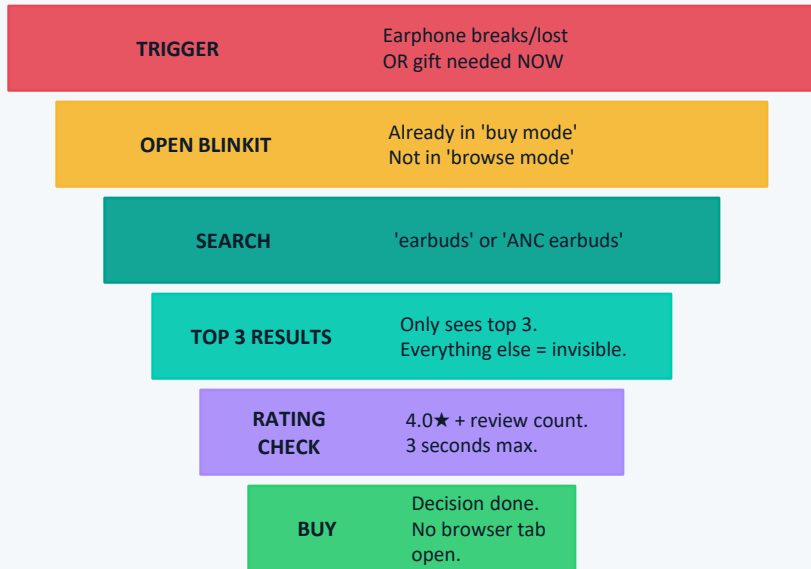
- Deep Teal matte case + feature badge = recognition before reading
- ANC badge · ENC badge · Easy Returns ✓ - same format, every time
- Visual identity is the product on Blinkit — not the spec sheet

AVOID: Celebrity campaigns · IPL 2026 (₹30–50L+, 0 survey respondents chose it) · 'Premium audio' framing · boAt comparison · 6+ SKU launch

Blinkit Decision Journey

How Consumers Actually Buy Earbuds on Quick Commerce - vs Amazon

BLINKIT FUNNEL



 **Total: <3 minutes**

AMAZON FUNNEL

TRIGGER	Wants new earbuds (planned purchase)
SEARCH	Google + Amazon research
BROWSE	Compares 5–10 products carefully
REVIEWS	Reads 20+ reviews in detail
COMPARE	Price + features matrix built
WAIT	Adds to cart; waits for sale event
BUY	Days or weeks after initial intent

 **Total: 3–7 days**

KEY: On Blinkit the WINNING variables are recognition + thumbnail + rating count - NOT features, NOT brand heritage. Design everything for a 3-second thumbnail decision.

06 · Platform Economics

Velocity Drives Everything. Slow-Sell Is the Real Risk.

⚠ **CORRECTION: Not a flat commission. Seller model = 2–3% commission + ₹1–5/unit/day storage + fixed delivery fee. Total cost is velocity-dependent.**

BUYER MODEL — Ubon will NOT get this

- Platform buys inventory upfront
- ~30% margin - no storage or delivery fee
- Reserved for Amul, Britannia. ~2% of new brands.

SELLER MODEL ★ Ubon's path

- Commission: ~2–3% of sell price
- Storage: ~₹1/day/unit (earbuds size)
- Delivery: fixed per order regardless of product value
- Entry: 10 stores → 100 → 400 → 1,000 (sell-through gated)

VELOCITY = THE KEY VARIABLE

Fast-sell 7-day · 1,200u/mo

Storage ₹7/unit

28–
34%

Slow-sell 21-day · 400u/mo

Storage
₹21/unit

14–
18%

07 · Consumer Survey

Reviews + Returns = The Two Trust Levers (n=18, directional)

87%+

Google before buying

Highest score in survey. Amazon + YouTube reviews must exist BEFORE Blinkit ads launch.

50%

Cite returns as #1 hesitation

Tied with 'price under ₹1,500'. No brand in sub-₹1,500 Blinkit TWS owns this slot.

0/18

Chose IPL as a trigger

Zero respondents selected IPL/RR as a convincing factor. Do not activate IPL 2026.

61%+

₹1,000+ impulse ceiling

₹1,499 sits at the top of the comfort zone. Strong listing + returns promise reduces risk.

Q15 TOP TRIGGERS:

Reviews 4.0★+ (10/18)

Easy returns (9/18)

Price <₹1,500 (9/18)

YouTube review (6/18)

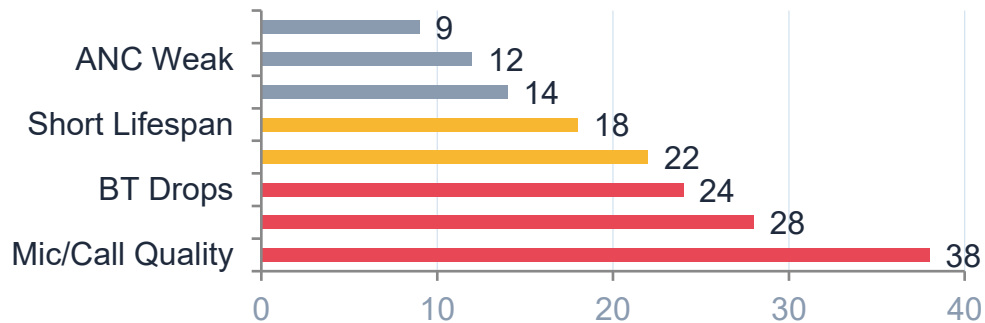
Friend rec (4/18)

CRITICAL IMPLICATION: 87%+ will Google Ubon before buying on Blinkit. Amazon review equity DIRECTLY drives Blinkit conversion. Build Amazon first.

Review Sentiment Analysis

What Consumers Are Actually Saying - The Real Voice of the Market

Top 1-Star Complaint Themes (%)



FEATURE SENTIMENT HEATMAP

Feature	Rating	Pain	Insight
Battery Life	★★★★	Medium	Positive when works; user rage when below claimed
Mic / ENC	★★	HIGH	#1 frustration - embarrassing on calls
Sound / Bass	★★★★	Low	Acceptable at price - positive surprise common
ANC	★★★★	Medium	Positive when ANC actually delivers
Build Quality	★★★★	Medium	3-month lifespan perception is widespread
After-Sales	★★	HIGH	Return denial reported - warranty confusion

REAL CONSUMER VOICES

"Used to sell Ubon like hell. Same quality, brand name is the difference."

- Quora - audio dealer

"From 80% battery the sound starts crackling. Connectivity is worse."

- YouTube (nexttodigital)

"Every product performs well only 3 months then malfunctions."

- Quora - verified buyer

"Thought cheap = bad. Was shocked — amazing for ₹120. Better than in-box Motorola."

- Quora - surprised buyer

CORE INSIGHT: Consumers FORGIVE average bass. They do NOT forgive call embarrassment. 6-mic ENC is the most defensible product claim Ubon can make.

08 · The Review Floor Unlocks Everything

250 reviews = Blinkit entry ticket. Policy-compliant seeding only.

36-56

Ubon NOW

CVR: 2–4%

ROAS: 1–2x

Ads destroy money



250

Pre-Blinkit

CVR: 12–15%

ROAS: 3–4x

Entry threshold



500+

Blinkit launch

CVR: 20–25%

ROAS: 4–6x

Self-sustaining



1,000+

Month 6

CVR: 28–35%

ROAS: 6–9x

Reduce ad spend

SEEDING BLUEPRINT - POLICY-COMPLIANT ONLY

Channel	Method	Reviews	Timeline	Budget	Impact
Dealer activation	200 dealers × ₹500/verified review	150–200	Wk 1–8	₹1L	BEST ROI
YouTube micro-influencers	20 creators (10K–100K) · honest unboxing	15–20 videos	Wk 4–12	₹3–5L	Trust transfer
Flipkart verified buyer	List Wk 1 — independent review surface	50–100	Wk 1–8	₹1–2L	Diversified
Reddit India organic	r/IndianGaming · no hard sell	20–30	Wk 4–10	₹50K	High trust

★ Dealer activation: 250 distributors × ₹500 = ₹1.25L for 250 organic reviews. Best CAC in the plan. Zero incremental overhead.

09 • Financial Model

34.4% Net Margin (Fast-Sell). 3 Scenarios. Fragile Assumptions Named.

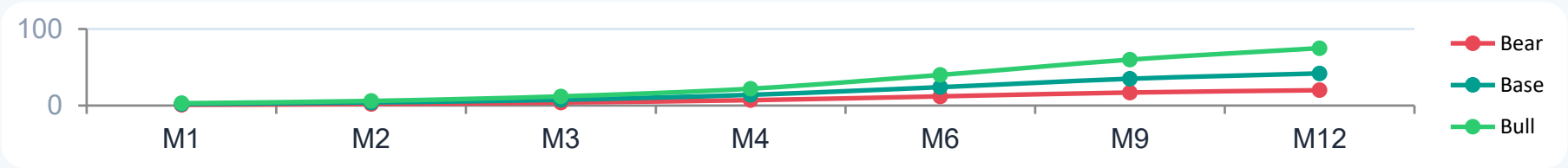
UNIT ECONOMICS • ₹1,499 • FAST-SELL

Line Item	Amount	% Revenue
Sell Price	₹1,499	100%
COGS (product + packaging)	-₹620	41.4%
Gross Margin	₹879	58.6%
Commission (~2.5%)	-₹37	2.5%
Storage (7-day avg)	-₹7	<1%
Delivery fee	-₹120	8%
Return provision (5%)	-₹75	5%
Contribution (pre-ad)	₹640	42.7%
Ad cost (ROAS 4x)	-₹125	8.3%
NET CONTRIBUTION	₹515	34.4%

Slow-sell (21-day): net drops to ~18–22%

3-SCENARIO PROJECTION

Metric	BEAR	BASE	BULL
Review floor Wk 10	200 reviews	250 reviews	400 reviews
Month 3 GMV	₹4L	₹7.5L	₹12L
Month 6 GMV	₹12L	₹24L	₹40L
Year 1 GMV	₹1.1Cr	₹2.7Cr	₹4.5Cr
Avg ROAS	2–3x	4–5x	6–8x
Net margin Mo 6	14–18%	28–34%	34–40%
Payback period	Mo 9–10	Mo 7–8	Mo 4–5



10 · Go-To-Market Plan

5 Phases. Each Gated. Capital Allocated Per Gate. Sequence Is Not Optional.

01 TRIAGE	02 FOUNDATION	03 LAUNCH	04 OPTIMISE	05 DEFEND
Wk 1–4 · ₹2–3L	Wk 5–16 · ₹8–12L	Wk 17–24 · ₹7–10L	Mo 6–9 · ₹5–8L	Mo 10–18 · ₹10–15L
Suppress J23/J26 — old reviews poison seeding window	New SKU sampled + bench-tested (50 units, zero-defect)	APOB GST Karnataka registration	Cut ads 20%; test organic rank stability	IPL 2027 activation (licensing cost confirmed first)
Lock hero SKU specs vs Boulton Z40 Ultra	Pro photoshoot: white bg, ANC + ENC + Returns badges	10 dark stores · 100 units each	Gaming TWS SKU 2 if demand data confirms	Ubon Brand Shelf on Blinkit
Submit BIS certification (8–16 wk lead time)	Flipkart listing live — independent review surface	Product Booster ads: ₹80K/month	Amazon re-entry: vendor model only	8+ SKU range: ₹499 wired → ₹2,499 pro TWS
Sign YGL retainer + designate internal owner	Dealer activation: 200 dealers × ₹500/review	A/B test: feature badge vs lifestyle thumbnail	Zepto/Instamart with validated playbook	Internal team owns ops; YGL advisory only

GATE: BIS filed. Old SKUs suppressed. YGL signed.

GATE: 250 Amazon reviews at 4.0+. Flipkart live.

GATE: ROAS >3x AND rank improving by Wk 24.

GATE: Organic top 20. ROAS 4x+. Returns <6%.

GATE: Top 10 rank. 1,000+ reviews. ₹40L/mo.

BIS certification is the true critical path — 8–16 weeks. File Week 1. Fast-track at ~₹50K premium. Everything blocks on it.

11 · Resource Reality

What Ubon Has. What to Outsource. What Not to Do.

Already Available

- **250+ distributor network**
Review activation at zero incremental cost
- **Blinkit seller account**
Already onboarded and live
- **Flipkart PO signed (₹18Cr)**
June delivery · vendor model · no return risk
- **Offline repair network**
15–20 points/city - better than 1 service center
- **IPL/RR Audio Partner**
Deferred to 2027 after review floor exists

Outsource to YGL

- **Daily Blinkit monitoring**
Inventory alerts, sell-through, rank tracking
- **Listing optimisation + A/B**
Cross-brand data = YGL's structural advantage
- **Influencer program**
20 YouTube creators · brief to delivery
- **Blinkit category manager**
YGL relationship — building takes quarters
- **Replenishment model**
Bulk RO Excel: SKU × dark store permutation

Do NOT Do Yet

- **Multi-city launch Day 1**
10 dark stores first - prove unit economics
- **Amazon seller model**
Return fraud history = capital destroyer
- **IPL 2026 activation**
₹30–50L+. 0 survey respondents chose it.
- **Celebrity campaigns**
Wrong ROI at this stage. No review floor yet.
- **6+ SKU launch**
Dispersed reviews kill ranking velocity

HIRE BY MONTH 4: Ecommerce manager (1 FTE) - shadow YGL ops, own independently by Mo 9. Content specialist (0.5 FTE) - listing quality non-negotiable at scale.

12 · Risk Matrix

Every Risk Has an Early Warning and a Recovery Plan. No Single Risk Is Fatal if Caught Within 2–4 Weeks.

P	Sev	Risk	Early Warning Signal	Recovery Action
H	CRITICAL	Firmware QC failure	1★ cluster within 2 weeks of seeding	Bench-test 50 units before any distribution. Zero-defect policy.
H	CRITICAL	BIS delayed >16 weeks	BIS portal 'under review' at Week 10	Engage BV/SGS lab Week 1. Fast-track at ~₹50K premium.
H	CRITICAL	Internal ops collapses	No response within 48hr on ops decisions	VP Ecom designated Week 1. Weekly KPI review mandatory.
M	HIGH	Slow sell-through (>21 days)	<30% inventory moved by Week 4	Reduce stores 10→5. Pause replenishment. Fix listing first.
M	HIGH	ROAS <2x after 6 weeks	Week 4 ROAS <2.5x	ROAS failure = listing problem. A/B test. Don't add budget.
H	HIGH	Old SKUs poison search	'Ubon earbuds review' returns 2023 negatives	Suppress J23/J26 before seeding. New SKU = BIS-clean.
H	HIGH	Blinkit stockout	Dark store drops below 30 units	YGL daily monitoring. 24hr replenishment SLA.
M	HIGH	Boult cuts to ₹1,199 ANC	Boult flash sale <₹1,299	Compete on review depth. Win on ENC mic + returns promise.
M	CRITICAL	Rating drops below 3.9	Return rate >8% in first 3 weeks	Halt listing. Diagnose before running any ads.

P = Probability: H = High (>60%) · M = Medium (30–60%) · No single risk is fatal if detected within the 2–4 week early warning window.

13 · Pre-Empting the 5 Questions Every Board Will Ask

Grounded in survey data, YGL session transcript, and boAt FY25 Annual Report.

1

How is this different from boAt at ₹1,299?

We are NOT competing on price. We compete on: (1) ENC mic depth - 6-mic vs boAt's 4-mic; (2) Returns as hero promise; (3) ₹1,499 with 40% MRP anchor. Different use case, different memory slot.

2

Why would anyone trust Ubon for earbuds?

Brand recall = 2.8/5 (near-neutral, not negative). Three trust levers: 250+ Amazon reviews before Blinkit listing · Returns badge on thumbnail · 70% Made-in-India. Gap is solvable through review equity, not brand spend.

3

What if Blinkit's algorithm changes or delists us?

Blinkit is not the only channel. Flipkart vendor (₹18Cr PO live). Amazon vendor model follows. The Blinkit playbook ports to Zepto and Instamart in Phase 4. No single-platform dependency by Month 9.

4

The financial model looks optimistic. What breaks it?

Three fragile assumptions explicitly disclosed: (1) ROAS $\geq 4x$ requires 250+ reviews - pre-reviews ads are waste; (2) Sell-through $\geq 50\%$ Month 1 or storage erodes margin; (3) Zero firmware failures in first 50 units.

5

Why not raise a round and launch bigger?

Seller model at 10 dark stores: <₹10L inventory commitment. Prove ROAS $> 4x$ before committing capital to 100+ stores. If proof-of-concept works, playbook scales without external capital. Downside: ₹30–40L - not existential.

14 · Action Priority

Sequenced for Capital Efficiency. The Order Is Not Optional.

MUST DO IMMEDIATELY

- Begin BIS certification - true critical path, everything blocks on it
- Suppress J23/J26 — old reviews will poison the new SKU seeding window
- Designate 1 internal Ubon ecommerce owner - strategy without operator fails
- Sign YGL retainer with Monday morning KPI cadence

MUST DO BEFORE BLINKIT

- Bench-test 50 new SKU units - zero defects before spending more
- 250 Amazon reviews at 4.0+ via dealer activation + YouTube organic only
- Listing assets: thumbnail, feature badges (ANC · ENC · Easy Returns ✓), white bg
- Flipkart vendor model live - second review surface, no return risk

HIGHEST ROI ACTIVITIES

- Dealer activation: 250 distributors × ₹500 = ₹1.25L for 250 reviews - best CAC in plan
- Branded search 'Ubon earphones' on Blinkit: ROAS 8–9x vs 4–6x on generic keywords
- Return policy hero badge - 50% hesitation factor, nobody owns it, zero cost
- Thumbnail A/B: feature badge vs lifestyle - decide within 2 weeks, follow data

AVOID ENTIRELY:

Amazon seller model (return fraud = capital destroyer at current scale) · IPL 2026 activation (₹30–50L+, 0 survey respondents chose it) · 6+ SKU launch

The Category Is Waiting.

The Consumers Are Ready.

The Execution Is All That Remains.

₹2.7Cr

Base Case Year 1 GMV

34.4%

Net margin fast-sell

16 Wks

Blinkit launch

₹39-47L

Year 1 Investment

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